

Ἀντίμαχος ὁ Κολοφώνιος

Antimachus of Colophon and the Fragments of the Thebaid

eul_aid: ehe

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἑπική](#) [Epic \(Homeric\)](#) (frg)
Domain: [Ποίησις](#) [Poetry](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Antimachus of Colophon was a Greek poet and scholar active around 400 BCE. Ancient sources describe him as a learned poet whose textual criticism of Homer influenced later Alexandrian scholars. Anecdotes highlight his erudite and difficult style, noting that he composed his elegy **Lyde** after the death of his beloved and that only Plato was an attentive audience for his epic **Thebaid**.

His works survive only in fragments. The major ones are the epic **Thebaid**, concerning the Seven Against Thebes; the long narrative elegy **Lyde**, which collected tales of tragic love; **Artemis**, a hexameter poem; and **Deltói**, a work of unknown content.

Antimachus is a pivotal figure bridging Classical and Hellenistic poetry. His learned, allusive, and deliberately obscure verse sparked a famous literary debate in Alexandria, with Callimachus rejecting his style and Crates of Mallus defending it. His scholarship and poetic aesthetic established him as a key precursor to Hellenistic poetics.

Works (4)

- [Ἐπίγραμμα](#) · [Epigram](#) · 6 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῆς Θηβαΐδος](#) · [Fragments of the Thebaid](#) · 169 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Μύθων καὶ Νεῶν](#) · [Fragments on Myth and Ships](#) · 18 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Θηβῶν καὶ Τιτάνων](#) · [Fragments on Thebes and Titans](#) · 43 passages